

SENDKIT DOCS

Google vs Azure vs SMTP: choosing mailbox providers

Which provider you send from changes how a campaign behaves. Here is how to think through the choice, and why most established senders end up running a mix.

Google

The strongest starting point if you are building a new cold email operation from scratch. Handles cold sending volume well and gives you the most room to scale as you add mailboxes.

[BEST DEFAULT](#)

Azure (Microsoft)

Costs less to run, which is attractive at scale, but a new Azure mailbox starts at just 1 email a day and ramps up from there. Build that slow start into your volume math from day one.

[ECONOMICAL, SLOWER RAMP](#)

SMTP

Fits specific infrastructure needs, most often integrating with an existing mail system or a setup that does not fit a standard Google or Microsoft mailbox. Not the default recommendation, but the right tool when your setup calls for it.

[SITUATIONAL](#)

Microsoft recipients

Business inboxes on Microsoft 365 tend to respond better once the sending domain is aged past 30 days. Sending to a Microsoft-heavy list from a newer domain will look quieter that first month; that is not a sign the list or copy is wrong.

[GIVE IT TIME](#)

Diversify instead of betting on one provider

Running mailboxes across more than one provider spreads your sending across more than one reputation system. If Google tightens something or a Microsoft policy shifts, a mixed setup means you are not fully exposed to one provider's changes. Most established senders end up running a mix rather than putting every mailbox on a single provider.

WHY THIS WORKS ON SENDKIT

Every mailbox on SendKit, whether Google, Azure, or SMTP, gets its own isolated IP. Your provider mix does not create shared reputation risk between mailboxes the way it can on platforms built on shared sending infrastructure.

Building a mixed fleet faster

Assembling and warming a mixed-provider mailbox fleet from scratch takes time. If that pace does not fit your timeline, InboxKit sells mailboxes across providers that arrive already warmed up, and imports directly into SendKit with an API key.

Next step

Whichever provider you choose, the mailbox still needs to earn its reputation before real sending through the warm-up process.

Check your provider mix

Open Mailboxes and review how your sending is split across Google, Azure, and SMTP before you add more.

[Check your provider mix](#)